

Dylan Dai

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EDUCATION

University of Waterloo

Bachelor of Computer Science (Honours)

Expected April 2028

Waterloo, Ontario

PUBLICATIONS

(ICML 2026) Investigating Component Contributions in Multi-Agent ML Systems

April 2026

First Author, equal contribution

- Ran **4,000+** controlled experiments on agents solving ML tasks, to study how agent design impacts performance
- Built K-LIVE, a continuously refreshed benchmark for evaluating ML agents on real-world competitions

WORK EXPERIENCE

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Research Intern
- Evaluations/Synthetic data work on core research team

September 2026 – December 2026

San Francisco, CA

Celestra

Founding Engineer

September 2025 – May 2026

San Francisco, CA

- **Employee #1** at seed stage startup backed by **General Catalyst** to enhance pharmaceutical market research
- Built an autonomous ML engineering agent capable of executing end-to-end research workflows for 24+ hours without human intervention, got **2nd place** on MLE-Bench and top **0.005% percentile** of Kaggle users in performance
- Worked with **three** of the top ten largest pharmaceutical firms to build a production analytics platform
- Built an RL post-training framework where ML engineering agents learn together, while working independently

Cohere

Software Engineer Intern

May 2025 – August 2025

Toronto, ON

- Saved **\$100,000+ monthly** by batching **all** company-wide outbound LLM calls, reducing LLM runtime by **35%**
- Built an evaluation ledger to access **all** of Cohere's benchmark results, preventing redundant evaluation jobs
- Provided **company-wide** LLM cost transparency by adding cost tracking for all outbound AI model calls

Cohere

Data Engineer Intern

August 2024 – April 2025

Toronto, ON

- Managed coding [datasets](#) used to train state-of-the-art machine learning model Command-A

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Canadian Computing Olympiad Bronze Medalist | Placed **14th** out of 10,000+ participants

Rubik's Cube Speedsolver | Solved the 3x3 Rubik's cube with a personal best of **6.21** seconds

National ranked Tetris player | **Top 50** global on tetris.com

PROJECTS

AI Dataset Undersampler

- Balances training data by using k-means to reduce overrepresented examples, to improve LLM model fairness

SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, SQL, C++, C, Bash, HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Tools: PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas, Git, AsyncIO, GCP, AWS, TensorFlow, Transformers, PostgreSQL

Interests: Fashion, Digital Art, Tetris, Puzzle Games, Thrifting, Guitar, Rubik's Cubes, Travelling